

Live Negotiation Simulations

Week 6 • Day 5 • SEP ships today

TPM Academy



Day 5 Objectives

- Run **3 simulated negotiation rounds**: Architecture/SLO, Scope, Resource/Timeline
- Surface the **trade space** (scope / time / quality / resources)
- Hold non-negotiables under pressure
- Capture each round in the **SEP §5 outcomes log** with owner + next step
- Sign off the SEP — the fourth and final sibling artifact



Today's Cadence (different)

Clock	Block
09:00 – 09:15	Opening; pairings posted; rubric reminder
09:15 – 10:45	Round 1: Architecture / SLO
10:45 – 11:00	Break
11:00 – 12:00	Round 1 debrief + Round 2 prep
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch
13:00 – 14:30	Round 2: Scope
14:30 – 14:45	Break
14:45 – 15:45	Round 3: Resource / Timeline
15:45 – 16:00	Wrap + sign-off

The Three Rounds

Each tests a different muscle



Round Structure

Round	Stakeholder type	Author tests
1: Architecture / SLO	High-power technical (Architect, Security, Eng Director)	Hold technical line; respond to surprise objections
2: Scope	Non-technical (PM Director, CS Lead, Sales VP)	Defend non-goals against scope-creep
3: Resource / Timeline	Executive (CFO, GM)	Negotiate against impossible asks via the trade space

Each round runs ~30 min: 5 prep + 15 negotiate + 10 debrief.



The Trade Space

Negotiation surfaces when **at least one of these can move**:

Scope

What's in

Time

When it ships

Quality / Resources

Polish level / who's
working

If nothing can move, you're not negotiating — you're saying yes or no.



The Negotiation Rubric (live scoring)

Dimension	Weight
Listened first	20%
Translated tech to business	20%
Held the line where it mattered	15%
Found the trade space	20%
Captured the outcome	15%
Body / pacing / closure	10%

Each side scores both. Same convention: 0–4 per dimension.

Round 1 — Architecture / SLO

Triad pairs • 90 minutes total

Author triad uses Day-3 brief + Day-4 objection map. Stakeholder triad has the brief + map + **1–2 surprise objections** from instructor.

- 5 min: prep
- 15 min: live negotiation
- 10 min: debrief + capture outcome
- (swap roles; repeat)



$5 + 15 + 10 \times 2$



Surprise Objection Examples

Architect

- "Other team rebuilds audit pipeline next quarter. Why now?"
- "Tickets module p95 is now 250ms, not 100ms — your budget breaks."

Security Lead

- "I need data-retention policy in writing before sign-off."
- "What stops a malicious client from replaying old idempotency keys?"

Eng Director

- "3 features competing for sprint slots — why yours wins?"
- "What's the velocity assumption behind your timeline?"

Round 2 — Scope

Triad pairs • 90 minutes

Stakeholder triad arrives with a **scope-creep ask**:

- "Marketing wants a manager-view dashboard before launch"
- "Top-3 customer just made tablet support a renewal condition"
- "In-flight deal requires multi-shop manager view"

Author defends PRD §3 non-goals + §11 follow-ups. Hold / cut / phase / escalate.



5 prep + 15 negotiate + 10 debrief × 2

Round 3 — Resource / Timeline

Fresh pairing • 60 minutes

Executive demands one of:

- "Ship 30% sooner. No scope cut offered."
- "Lost an engineer to higher priority. Same scope, same date."
- "Add adjacent feature. Same date, same team."

Author surfaces all 4 trade-space axes; offers movement on 2; protects non-negotiables.



5 + 15 + 10



SEP §5 Outcomes Log Entry

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### Round N: <topic>
**Triad A (author):** ... | **Triad B (stakeholder):** ...
**Stakeholder role:** ...

<p><strong>The ask:</strong> ...
<strong>Stakeholder's response:</strong> top 1-2 objections
<strong>Trade space surfaced:</strong> what offered to move; what held
<strong>Agreement:</strong> what was agreed; or "deferred to <date>"; or
"disagreed; escalation to <person>"
<strong>Owner + next step:</strong> specific
<strong>What we learned:</strong> one sentence
<strong>Score:</strong></person></date></p>
</topic>
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<li>Author: total /4.0</li>
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- Stakeholder: total /4.0



Week 6 Wrap

What we shipped

- Stakeholder map (P×I + RACI + watch list)
- Engagement plan
- 1-page trade-off brief
- Meeting prep + objection map
- 3 negotiation outcomes (live)
- Integrated SEP — 4th sibling artifact

What opens Week 7

- **Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery**
- Negotiated commitments → sprint planning
- Outcome vs output tracking
- Value stream mapping

Bring to Monday: PRD + TCD + TMD + SEP. The full set of artifacts is now your delivery input.

Questions & Reflection

Where in today's negotiation did you wish you'd held the line harder?